

006. Chapter 2 Verses 17-18

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.17

अविनाशि तु तद्विद्धि येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ।
विनाशमव्ययस्यास्य न कश्चित्कर्तुमर्हति ॥ 17 ॥

*avināśhi tu tadviddhi yena sarvam idam tatam
vināśham avyayasyāsyā na kaśhchit kartum arhati*

avināśhi—indestructible; **tu**—indeed; **tat**—that; **viddhi**—know; **yena**—by whom; **sarvam**—entire; **idam**—this; **tatam**—pervaded; **vināśham**—destruction; **avyayasya**—of the imperishable; **asya**—of it; **na kaśhchit**—no one; **kartum**—to cause; **arhati**—is able

(O Arjuna!) Know that Atma by which the whole universe is pervaded is indestructible. No one can cause the destruction of the imperishable.

VERSE 2.18

अन्तवन्त इमे देहा नित्यस्योक्ताः शरीरिणः ।
अनाशिनोऽप्रमेयस्य तस्माद्युध्यस्व भारत ॥ 18 ॥

*antavanta ime dehā nityasyoktāḥ śharīraṇaḥ
anāśhino 'prameyasya tasmād yudhyasva bhārata*

anta-vantaḥ—having an end; **ime**—these; **dehāḥ**—material bodies; **nityasya**—eternally; **uktāḥ**—are said; **śharīraṇaḥ**—of the embodied soul; **anāśhinaḥ**—indestructible; **aprameyasya**—immeasurable; **tasmāt**—therefore; **yudhyasva**—fight; **bhārata**—descendant of Bharat, Arjun

These bodies which belong to the real imperishable, unknowable Atma are said to be subject to an end; therefore fight, O Arjuna!